

Topic 3: Computers

Students must be familiar with the hardware and software components that make up a computer system.

Subject content	Students should:
3.1 Hardware	3.1.1 understand the von Neumann stored program concept and the role of main memory (RAM), CPU (control unit, arithmetic logic unit, registers), clock, address bus, data bus, control bus in the fetch-decode-execute cycle
	3.1.2 understand the role of secondary storage and the ways in which data is stored on devices (magnetic, optical, solid state)
	3.1.3 understand the concept of an embedded system and what embedded systems are used for